Weight Optimization: Earn $10-$25 More Per Visit

Plasma Pay Calculator — plasmapaycalculator.com

How Weight Affects Your Pay

Plasma centers pay based on how much plasma they can collect, which is determined by your weight. There are typically 3 tiers:

Tier	Weight Range	Plasma Volume	Typical Pay
Tier 1	110-149 lbs	690 mL	$30-45
Tier 2	150-174 lbs	825 mL	$40-55
Tier 3	175+ lbs	880 mL	$50-75

The Math: Why 1 Tier Makes a Big Difference

	Tier 1 (130 lbs)	Tier 2 (155 lbs)	Tier 3 (180 lbs)
Per Visit	$40	$50	$65
Per Month (8 visits)	$320	$400	$520
Per Year (100 visits)	$4,000	$5,000	$6,500
Annual Difference	Baseline	**+$1,000**	**+$2,500**

How to Move Up a Tier (Safely)

- **If you're 145-149 lbs:** Gaining 1-5 lbs moves you to Tier 2 (+$1,000/year)
- **Healthy weight gain:** Increase protein intake, add strength training
- **Weigh-in tips:** Wear heavier clothes, hydrate well (water adds weight)
- **Don't:** Unhealthily gain weight just for plasma pay — focus on muscle
- **Track:** Know your weight before each visit to stay in the optimal tier

Weight Tier Strategy by Center

Center	Weigh-in Timing	Clothing Policy	Notes
BioLife	Every visit	Can wear clothes/shoes	Consistent scales
CSL Plasma	Every visit	Shoes on at most locations	May vary by location
Grifols	Every visit	Varies by location	Ask your center
Octapharma	Every visit	Standard clothing OK	Check with staff

Pro Tip: If you're right at a tier boundary, weighing in with shoes and a hoodie can add 2-3 lbs. Over 100 visits/year, that's an extra $1,000+.